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Target path generation system

Abstract

A target locus of an attachment is determined while a calculation load for generating the target locus of the attachment is suppressed. A controller is configured to set a position of an arm distal end at a time when a contact detector detects contact of a bucket distal end with an excavation object at a start point of an arm distal end target locus. The controller is configured to receive information about a form of the arm distal end target locus in advance. The controller is configured to set a position for a finish point on the basis of an angle of a surface of the excavation object, an intersection angle between the arm distal end target locus and the surface of the excavation object, information about the form of the arm distal end target locus, and an offset amount about the finish point of the arm distal end target locus.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to a target locus generation system that generates a target locus of an attachment included in a working machine.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) For instance, Patent Literature 1 describes an invention for generating a target locus (a recommended line for a bucket tip in Patent Literature 1) of an attachment.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(3) Patent Literature 1: International Unexamined Patent Publication No. 2017/115810

(4) The technology described in Patent Literature 1 fails to show how to generate the target locus of the attachment in detail. Further, suppression of a calculation load is demanded in generating the target locus of the attachment.

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(5) An object of the present invention is to provide a target locus generation system that enables determination of a target locus of an attachment while suppressing a calculation load for generating the target locus.

(6) A target locus generation system is adoptable for a working machine that has a machine main body and an attachment. The attachment includes a boom tiltably attached to the machine main body, an arm rotatably attached to the boom, and a bucket rotatably attached to the arm for excavating an excavation object. The target locus generation system includes: a posture detector that detects a posture of the attachment; a contour detector that detects information about a contour of the excavation object; a contact detector that detects contact of a distal end of the bucket with the excavation object; and a controller. The controller is configured to receive information about a form of an arm distal end target locus being a target locus of a distal end of the arm, information about an intersection angle being an angle between a surface of the excavation object and the arm distal end target locus, and information about an offset amount being a distance between a finish point of the arm distal end target locus and the surface of the excavation object. The controller is configured to set a position of the distal end of the arm at a time when the contact detector detects a change to a state of the contact of the distal end of the bucket with the excavation object from a state of no contact with the excavation object at a start point of the arm distal end target locus. The controller is configured to set a position for the finish point of the arm distal end target locus on the basis of the contour of the excavation object detected by the contour detector, the intersection angle, the information about the form of the arm distal end target locus, and the offset amount.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a side view of a working machine that adopts a target locus generation system according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of the target locus generation system shown in FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a side view of a target locus T of each of a bucket and an arm distal end illustrated in FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is an enlarged view of a periphery around a finish point P3 in FIG. 3.

(5) FIG. 5 is an illustration of an example of a rotation of the bucket after the arm distal end illustrated in FIG. 3 reaches the finish point P3.

(6) FIG. 6 is an illustration of an example of shifting of the arm distal end and a rotation of the bucket after the arm distal end illustrated in FIG. 3 reaches the finish point P3.

(7) FIG. 7 is an illustration corresponding to FIG. 3 except that a tilt of a surface A1 shown in FIG. 3 is steeper than that of the surface in the example shown in FIG. 3.

(8) FIG. 8 is an illustration corresponding to FIG. 3 except that a surface A1 is planar unlike the surface in FIG. 3.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(9) A target locus generation system 1 will be described with reference to FIG. 1 to FIG. 8. FIG. 1 is a side view of a working machine 10 that adopts a target locus generation system 1. FIG. 2 is a block diagram of the target locus generation system 1 shown in FIG. 1. FIG. 3 is a side view of a target locus T of each of a bucket 17 and an arm distal end 15t illustrated in FIG. 1.

(10) The target locus generation system 1 generates a target locus T of an attachment 12 as shown in FIG. 3. The target locus generation system 1 is adopted for the working machine 10 illustrated in

FIG. 1, and includes a posture detector **20**, a contour detector **31**, a contact detector **33**, and a controller **40** each shown in FIG. 2. The target locus generation system **1** may include the working machine **10**.

(11) The working machine **10** causes the bucket **17** to perform an excavation work, and is in the form of an excavator as illustrated in FIG. 1. For instance, the working machine **10** is a construction machine that performs a construction work. The working machine **10** includes a machine main body **11**, the attachment **12**, and a drive control part **19** (see FIG. 2).

(12) The machine main body **11** indicates a main body of the working machine **10**. The machine main body **11** includes a lower traveling body **11a** and an upper slewing body **11b**. The lower traveling body **11a** causes the working machine **10** to travel. The lower traveling body **11a** includes, for example, a crawler. The upper slewing body **11b** is mounted on the lower traveling body **11a** slewably about a slewing axis extending in upward and downward directions. A boom **13** (to be described later) included in the working machine **10** is attached to the upper slewing body **11b**.

(13) Directions

(14) Directions in which the slewing axis of the upper slewing body **11b** with respect to the lower traveling body **11a** extends are defined as upward and downward directions Z. Of the upward and downward directions Z, a direction or orientation from the lower traveling body **11a** to the upper slewing body **11b** is defined as an upward direction Z1 and a direction opposite thereto is defined as a downward direction Z2. A direction in which a rotation axis of the boom **13** (to be described later) in rising or lowering with respect to the upper slewing body **11b** extends is defined as a lateral direction Y. Directions perpendicularly intersecting each of the upward and downward directions Z and the lateral direction Y are defined as forward and rearward directions X. Of the forward and rearward directions X, a direction in which the attachment **12** protrudes from the upper slewing body **11b** is defined as a forward direction X1 (farther side or position) and a direction opposite thereto is defined as a rearward direction X2 (closer side or position).

(15) The attachment **12** is included in the working machine **10** to perform an operation, and includes the boom **13**, an arm **15**, and a bucket **17**. The boom **13** is tiltably attached to the upper slewing body **11b** (rotatably in the upward and downward directions Z). The arm **15** is rotatably attached to the boom **13**. The arm **15** has a distal end (that is opposite to an end of the arm attached to the boom **13**) defined as an arm distal end **15t** (arm top).

(16) The bucket **17** excavates an excavation object A. The bucket **17** has such a shape as to scoop the excavation object A. The bucket **17** is provided on a distal end of the attachment **12** (that is opposite to an end of the attachment attached to the upper slewing body **11a**). The bucket **17** is rotatably attached to the arm **15**. Specifically, the bucket **17** is attached to the arm distal end **15t** via an unillustrated pin (arm top pin). The bucket **17** has a bucket opening plane **17a** and a bucket distal end **17t** as illustrated in FIG. 3. The bucket opening plane **17a** meets an unillustrated opening of the bucket **17** to communicate with an inside of the bucket **17**. The bucket distal end **17t** is a distal end of the bucket **17** (that is opposite to an end of the bucket attached to the arm **15**) to serve as an end edge of the bucket **17**.

(17) Examples of the excavation object A to be excavated by the bucket **17** may include soil and sand, and another object, e.g., metal, resin, and rubber, other than the soil and sand. The excavation object A has a surface A1 which may be a planar surface (see FIG. 8) horizontally expanding, or a slope slanted to a horizontal plane. The surface A1 may be planar, substantially planar, or curvy.

(18) The drive control part **19** (FIG. 2) actuates the working machine **10** illustrated in FIG. 1. For instance, the drive control part **19** includes a hydraulic actuator that drives the working machine **10**, and an unillustrated hydraulic circuit that controls the hydraulic actuator. The hydraulic actuator constituting the drive control part **19** includes: an unillustrated slewing motor to slew the upper slewing body **11b** with respect to the lower traveling body **11a**; a boom cylinder **19a**; an arm cylinder **19b**; and a bucket cylinder **19c**. The boom cylinder **19a** extends and contracts to lower and

raise the boom **13** with respect to the upper slewing body **11b**. The arm cylinder **19b** extends and contracts to rotate the arm **15** with respect to the boom **13**. The bucket cylinder **19c** extends and contracts to rotate the bucket **17** with respect to the arm **15**. The drive control part **19** controls an operation of the attachment **12** by controlling a rotation of the slewing motor and controlling the extension and the contraction of each of the boom cylinder **19a**, the arm cylinder **19b**, and the bucket cylinder **19c**.

(19) The posture detector **20** detects a posture (position, angle) of the attachment **12**. The posture detector **20** includes a slewing angle sensor **21**, a boom angle sensor **22**, an arm angle sensor **23**, and a bucket angle sensor **24**. The slewing angle sensor **21** detects a slewing angle of the upper slewing body **11b** to the lower traveling body **11a**. The boom angle sensor **22** detects a rotation angle or a tilt angle of the boom **13** to the upper slewing body **11b**. The boom angle sensor **22** may include an angle sensor attached to a rotary shaft of the boom **13** with respect to the upper slewing body **11b**. Similarly, each of the slewing angle sensor **21**, the arm angle sensor **23**, and the bucket angle sensor **24** may include an angle sensor. The boom angle sensor **22** may include a tilt sensor that detects a tilt angle of the boom **13** to the horizontal plane. Similarly, each of the arm angle sensor **23** and the bucket angle sensor **24** may include a tilt sensor. The boom angle sensor **22** may include a stroke sensor that detects a stroke of the boom cylinder **19a**. Similarly, each of the arm angle sensor **23** and the bucket angle sensor **24** may detect a stroke of the corresponding cylinder. The boom angle sensor **22** may detect a posture of the boom **13** on the basis of a two-dimensional image or a distance image. For example, the contour detector **31** may serve as the boom angle sensor as well. Similarly, the contour detector may serve as each of the slewing angle sensor **21**, the arm angle sensor **23**, and the bucket angle sensor **24**. The arm angle sensor **23** detects a rotation angle of the arm **15** to the boom **13**. The bucket angle sensor **24** detects a rotation angle of the bucket **17** to the arm **15**. The bucket angle sensor **24** may detect a rotation angle of the bucket **17** to the arm **15** by detecting a posture (e.g., a tilt angle) of a link member connected to the bucket **17** and the arm **15**.

(20) The posture detector **20** may detect a position of the working machine **10** on a worksite by using a positioning system (e.g., satellite positioning system). For instance, the posture detector **20** may detect the posture of the attachment **12** on the worksite by detecting a position and an orientation of the upper slewing body **11b** on the worksite by using the positioning system. The positioning system may be a satellite positioning system, e.g., GNSS (global navigation satellite system). The positioning system may adopt a total station. When the posture detector **20** includes the satellite positioning system, the posture detector **20** may have an antenna to receive a signal for the satellite positioning.

(21) The contour detector **31** detects or acquires information (e.g., a surface angle α to be described later) about a contour of the excavation object A. For instance, the contour detector **31** detects three-dimensional information about a position and a contour of the excavation object A. As an example, the contour detector **31** serves as a photographing device that acquires an image or a distance image having information about a distance (information on a farther position). The contour detector **31** may detect three-dimensional information about the excavation object A on the basis of the distance image and a two-dimensional image. A contour acquisition part that acquires information about the contour of the excavation object A from a storage part may be provided in place of the contour detector **31**.

(22) The contour detector **31** may be solely provided as described above, or a plurality of contour detectors **31** may be provided. The contour detector **31** may be mounted to the working machine **10**, or arranged on an outside (e.g., the worksite) of the working machine **10**. Each of the posture detector **20**, the contact detector **33**, and the controller **40** shown in FIG. 2 may be arranged in the same manner. The arrangement of the contour detector **31** shown in FIG. 1 on the outside of the working machine **10** may enable detection of a portion (e.g., a shade portion of the attachment **12**) which is not detectable in the arrangement of the contour detector **31** in the working machine **10**.

Further, the arrangement of the contour detector **31** on the outside of the working machine **10** makes the target locus generation system **1** according to the embodiment applicable to a working machine **10** that does not include such a contour detector **31**.

(23) The contour detector **31** may include a device that detects three-dimensional information by using a laser beam, for example, may include a LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging, or a Laser Imaging detection and Ranging), or may include a TOF (Time of Flight sensor). The contour detector **31** may include a device (e.g., a millimeter-wave radar) that detects three-dimensional information by using radio waves. The contour detector **31** may include a stereo camera. The contour detector **31** may include a camera that can detect a two-dimensional image in a case where the contour detector **31** detects a three-dimensional position and a three-dimensional contour of the excavation object A on the basis of three-dimensional information and two-dimensional information.

(24) The contact detector **33** (see FIG. 2) detects contact of the bucket distal end **17t** with the excavation object A. For instance, the contact detector **33** may detect the contact of the bucket distal end **17t** with the excavation object A by detecting a pressure acting on the hydraulic cylinder (e.g., the bucket cylinder **19c**) to actuate the attachment **12**. The contact detector **33** may detect the contact of the bucket distal end **17t** with the excavation object A on the basis of a two-dimensional image or a distance image showing the bucket **17** and the excavation object A. In this case, the two-dimensional image or distance image may be detected as a result from the contour detector **31**.

(25) The controller **40** executes input and output of a signal, calculation or computation (processing), and storing of information, as shown in FIG. 2. For instance, the controller **40** acquires information about a posture of the attachment **12** (see FIG. 1) detected by the posture detector **20**. For example, the controller **40** stores a result of the calculation. The controller **40** serves as an automatic operative controller that controls the working machine **10** (see FIG. 1) to automatically operate. The controller **40** controls the operation of the attachment **12** in such a manner that the attachment **12** shifts along the target locus T illustrated in FIG. 3. The controller **40** includes a CPU (Central Processing Unit), a ROM (Read Only Memory) which stores a control program, and a RAM (Random Access Memory) for use as a work area of the CPU. As shown in FIG. 2, when the CPU executes the control program stored in the ROM, the controller **40** serves to include functional parts of an intersection angle setting part **41** (intersection angle receiving part), an offset amount setting part **42** (offset amount receiving part), a finish point bucket posture setting part **43** (finish point bucket posture receiving part), a bucket rotation ratio setting part **44** (bucket rotation ratio receiving part), a target locus generation part **45**, and an instruction part **46**. The functional parts have no entities, and respectively correspond to units of functions to be executed by the control program. That is to say, the controller **40** can practically and comprehensively execute the control to be executed by the functional parts. The functional parts may be respectively allotted to a plurality of controllers. In this case, the controllers constitute the controller of the present invention.

(26) The intersection angle setting part **41** sets an intersection angle β (see FIG. 3) to be described later, in other words, receives information about the intersection angle β . The offset amount setting part **42** sets an offset amount O to be described later, in other words, receives information about the offset amount O. The finish point bucket posture setting part **43** sets a finish point bucket posture Q3 (see FIG. 3) to be described later, in other words, receives information about the finish point bucket posture Q3. The bucket rotation ratio setting part **44** sets a bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ to be described later, in other words, receives information about the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$.

(27) The target locus generation part **45** generates a target locus T (target path, see FIG. 3) to be described later. The instruction part **46** controls the attachment **12** in such a manner that the attachment **12** shifts along the target locus T illustrated in FIG. 3. The instruction part **46** shown in FIG. 2 inputs an instruction of a target speed of each actuator (e.g., the boom cylinder **19a**, see FIG. 1) to the drive control part **19** on the basis of a difference between information about the target

locus T and information about a current posture of the attachment **12** (see FIG. 1).

(28) Target Locus T

(29) The target locus T illustrated in FIG. 3 is generated by the target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2). The target locus T includes an arm distal end target locus Ta and a bucket target locus Tb.

(30) The arm distal end target locus Ta is a target locus T of the arm distal end **15t**. The target locus generation part **45** sets, acquires, or receives information about a form of the arm distal end target locus Ta in advance (before generation of the target locus T). The term “information about a form of the arm distal end target locus Ta” means information specifying what form the arm distal end target locus Ta has. The form of the arm distal end target locus Ta is variously settable.

Example A1

(31) For instance, the arm distal end target locus Ta is set to be linear. This configuration suppresses a calculation load by the target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) more effectively than a configuration in which the arm distal end target locus Ta is not linear.

Example A2

(32) For instance, the arm distal end target locus Ta may be substantially linear, curvy, polylinear, or linear and curvy in combination. In the case of the “curvy” form, at least a part of the form may be an arc, a circular arc, or a substantially circular arc.

(33) The controller **40** (see FIG. 2) controls the attachment **12** in such a manner that the arm distal end **15t** shifts along the arm distal end target locus Ta. An actual shifting locus of the arm distal end **15t** does not need to exactly agree with the arm distal end target locus Ta. For instance, the actual shifting locus of the arm distal end **15t** may be substantially linear even when the arm distal end target locus Ta is linear.

(34) The arm distal end target locus Ta viewed in the lateral direction Y may tilt with respect to the upward and downward directions Z, may be in the upward and downward directions Z, or may be in the forward and rearward directions X. For example, the arm distal end target locus Ta viewed in the forward and rearward directions X (not shown) may be in or be substantially in the upward and downward directions Z. In this case, the upper slewing body **11b** illustrated in FIG. 1 does not slew or does not substantially slew with respect to the lower traveling body **11a** in the shifting of the arm distal end **15t** along the arm distal end target locus Ta. As illustrated in FIG. 3, the arm distal end target locus Ta bears a start point P1, a finish point P3, and an intermediate point P2.

(35) The start point P1 is a point of the arm distal end target locus Ta at which the arm distal end **15t** starts to shift. The finish point P3 is a point of the arm distal end target locus Ta at which the shifting of the arm distal end **15t** finishes. The intermediate point P2 is a specific point between the start point P1 and the finish point P3. For example, the intermediate point P2 may be a middle point between the start point P1 and the finish point P3, or may be a specific point other than the middle point between the start point P1 and the finish point P3. Here, a plurality of intermediate points P2 may be set.

(36) The bucket target locus Tb is a target locus T of the bucket **17**. The bucket target locus Tb indicates information about a posture (a position and an angle) of the bucket **17** at a time when the arm distal end **15t** shifts from the start point P1 to the finish point P3. For instance, the bucket target locus Tb may include information about an angle of the bucket **17** with respect to a reference direction. Besides, for example, the bucket target locus Tb may include information about an angle or a bucket rotation angle θ of the bucket opening plane **17a** with respect to a horizontal direction H. The bucket target locus Tb may include information on a position of the bucket distal end **17t**. Hereinafter, the bucket target locus Tb including the information about the bucket rotation angle θ will be mainly described. The posture of the bucket **17** includes a start point bucket posture Q1, a finish point bucket posture Q3, and an intermediate point bucket posture Q2.

(37) The start point bucket posture Q1 is a posture of the bucket **17** at a time when the arm distal end **15t** is at the start point P1. More specifically, the start point bucket posture Q1 is a posture of the bucket **17** detected by the posture detector **20** when the arm distal end **15t** is at the start point

P1. The finish point bucket posture Q3 is a posture of the bucket **17** at a time when the arm distal end **15t** is at the finish point P3. The intermediate point bucket posture Q2 is a posture of the bucket **17** at a time when the arm distal end **15t** is at the intermediate point P2. The target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) sets the bucket target locus Tb in such a manner that the bucket **17** continuously changes from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3. A direction in which the bucket **17** rotates in the change of the posture of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3 agrees with a direction in which the bucket **17** excavates the excavation object A (in which the bucket rotation angle θ increases in the example shown in FIG. 3). A rotation speed of the bucket **17** in the change of the posture of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3 may be constant or may vary (see the description below about the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$).

(38) Information Set Before Generation of the Target Locus T

(39) As described above, the target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) sets, receives an input of, or acquires information about the form of the arm distal end target locus Ta before the target locus generation part **45** generates the target locus T in advance. Besides, the controller **40** (see FIG. 2) sets, receives an input of, or acquires an intersection angle β , an offset amount O, a finish point bucket posture Q3, and a bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ before the target locus generation part **45** generates the target locus T in advance.

(40) The intersection angle β is an angle between the arm distal end target locus Ta and the surface A1 of the excavation object A. In a case where the arm distal end target locus Ta is linear, the intersection angle β indicates, for example, an angle defined by the surface angle α detected by the contour detector **31** (see FIG. 2) and the arm distal end target locus Ta. As shown in FIG. 1, the surface angle α is an angle of the surface A1 of the excavation object A to a horizontal plane (a ground surface, or a predetermined reference plane). In a case where the arm distal end target locus Ta is not linear (e.g., is curvy), the intersection angle β may be an angle between: a straight line passing through the start point P1 and the finish point P3; and the surface A1 of the excavation object A. Further, in the case where the arm distal end target locus Ta is not linear, the intersection angle β may be an angle between a direction (e.g., tangent line) in which the arm distal end target locus Ta extends on the start point P1 and the surface A1 of the excavation object A. The intersection angle β is set by, input to, or acquired by the intersection angle setting part **41** (see FIG. 2). The intersection angle β may be a fixed value, may be a value manually input by an operator, or may be a value automatically calculated by the controller **40** under a specific condition. Similarly, each of the offset amount O, the finish point bucket posture Q3, and the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ may have a value calculated in the same manner.

(41) For instance, as the intersection angle β is larger, the excavation object A is excavated deeper and an excavation quantity of the excavation object A is greater. As the intersection angle β is smaller, the excavation object A is excavated shallower and the excavation quantity of the excavation object A is smaller. For instance, when the excavation quantity of the excavation object A is too excessive, the excavation object A is more likely to spill out of the bucket **17**. By contrast, when the excavation quantity of the excavation object A is too small, the work efficiency of excavation is low. Here, an appropriate setting of the intersection angle β allows the excavation quantity of the excavation object A to be appropriate.

(42) For instance, as the intersection angle β is larger, the load applied to the attachment **12** is greater. As the intersection angle β is smaller, the load applied to the attachment **12** is smaller. The appropriate setting of the intersection angle β allows the load applied to the attachment **12** to be appropriate. For instance, as the excavation object A is harder, the load applied to the attachment **12** becomes greater. In a case where the load applied to the attachment **12** is too excessive, a setting of the intersection angle β to a smaller value suppresses the load applied to the attachment **12** (enables release of the load).

(43) FIG. 4 is an enlarged view of a periphery around the finish point P3 in FIG. 3. As shown in

FIG. 4, the offset amount O is a distance between the finish point P3 and the surface A1. The offset amount O may be a vertical directional distance (vertical directional offset amount O1) between the finish point P3 and the surface A1. Also, the offset amount O may be a distance (extension directional offset amount O2) between the finish point P3 and the surface A1 in a direction in which the arm distal end target locus Ta extends. The offset amount O may indicate a distance (now shown) between the finish point P3 and the surface A1 in a direction perpendicularly intersecting the surface A1.

(44) The offset amount O is set by, acquired by, or input to the offset amount setting part 42 (see FIG. 2). The finish point P3 may be on the surface A1. In other words, the offset amount O may be zero. The finish point P3 may be set above the surface A1. The offset amount O in this case is defined as a positive value. The finish point P3 may be set below the surface A1. The offset amount O in this case is defined as a negative value. As the offset amount O is smaller, the excavation object A is excavated deeper. As the offset amount O is greater, the excavation object A is excavated shallower. An appropriate setting of the offset amount O allows the excavation quantity of the excavation object A to be appropriate and allows the load applied to the attachment 12 to be appropriate (in the same manner as the setting of the intersection angle β).

(45) For instance, the offset amount O is set so that a position for the finish point P3 comes near the surface A1. Specifically, in a view in the lateral direction Y as shown in FIG. 3, a direct distance from the rotation center (the start point P1 in FIG. 3) of the bucket 17 to the bucket distal end 17t with respect to the arm 15 is defined as a “length of the bucket opening plane 17a”. When the offset amount O has a positive value, the offset amount O (the vertical directional offset amount O1, see FIG. 4, or the extension directional offset amount O2) may be 50% of the length of the bucket opening plane 17a or less, may be 40% thereof or less, may be 30% thereof or less, may be 20% thereof or less, or may be 10% thereof or less. The offset amount O may be 0% of the length of the bucket opening plane 17a or more, may be 10% thereof or more, may be 20% thereof or more, may be 30% thereof or more, may be 40% or more, or may be 50% or more. For instance, when the load applied to the attachment 12 is suppressed, the offset amount O may be preferably 30% of the length of the bucket opening plane 17a or more, more preferably 40% thereof or more, and still more preferably 50% thereof or more. For instance, in an attempt to ensure a maximal excavation quantity of the excavation object A, the offset amount O may be preferably 20% of the length of the bucket opening plane 17a or less, more preferably 10% thereof or less, or still more preferably 0% thereof or less (that is, the finish point P3 is preferably at the same height level as the surface A1 or below the surface A1).

(46) For instance, the offset amount O is set in such a manner that an entirety or substantially entirety of the bucket opening plane 17a at a time when the bucket 17 is in the finish point bucket posture Q3 is located in an inner position than the surface A1 (in front of and below the surface A1) before excavation. For instance, a proportion of the bucket opening plane 17a (which is a specific example of the “entirety or substantially entirety”) in the inner position than the surface A1 before the excavation in the finish point bucket posture Q3 may be 50% or more, may be 60% or more, may be 70% or more, may be 80% or more, may be 90% or more, or may be 100%. The proportion may be 90% or less, may be 80% or less, may be 70% or less, may be 60% or less, or 50% or less. For instance, in an attempt to suppress the load applied to the attachment 12, the proportion is preferably 80% or less, more preferably 70% or less, still more preferably 60% or less, and further more preferably 50% or less. For example, in an attempt to ensure a maximal excavation quantity of the excavation object A, the proportion is preferably 80% or more, more preferably 90% or more, and still more preferably 100%.

(47) The finish point bucket posture Q3 is set by, acquired by, or input to the finish point bucket posture setting part 43 (see FIG. 2). For instance, the finish point bucket posture Q3 is set as a posture (at a bucket rotation angle θ of 90° or substantially 90°) that the bucket opening plane 17a extends in a vertical direction or a substantially vertical direction. The bucket rotation angle θ in the

finish point bucket posture Q3 may not be 90° or substantially 90°.

(48) The bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ is set by, acquired by, or input to the bucket rotation ratio setting part **44** (see FIG. 2). The bucket rotation ratio $2\theta_ratio$ is a ratio of a posture change amount of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 with respect to a posture change amount of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3. Specifically, the bucket rotation angle θ changes from 45° at the start point P1 to 90° at the finish point P3, and the bucket rotation angle θ indicates 60° at the intermediate point P2. In this case, a change amount of the bucket rotation angle θ from the start point P1 to the finish point P3 is 45°. The change amount of the bucket rotation angle θ from the start point P1 to the intermediate point P2 is 15°. In this case, the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ is 15/45, that is, about 33%. The numerical value of the bucket rotation angle θ is just an example, and the bucket rotation angle θ from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3 may be variously settable.

(49) Generation of the Target Locus T

(50) The target locus T is generated in a manner described below.

(51) Detection of the Contour of the Excavation Object A.

(52) The contour detector **31** shown in FIG. 1 detects information about the contour of the excavation object A. Specifically, the contour detector **31** detects an angle of the surface A1 (surface angle α). For instance, the contour detector **31** detects the surface angle α of the surface A1 at a position where the bucket **17** is about to excavate or therearound. The surface angle α is an angle of the surface A1 with respect to a reference direction (i.e., the horizontal direction H).

(53) Determination of the Start Point P1 and the Start Point Bucket Posture Q1

(54) The position for the start point P1 and the start point bucket posture Q1 illustrated in FIG. 3 are determined in a manner described below. The contact detector **33** (FIG. 2) detects a change to a state of contact of the bucket distal end **17t** with the excavation object A from a state of no contact with the excavation object. The target locus generation part **45** (FIG. 2) sets a position of the arm distal end **15t** at this time at the start point P1. The target locus generation part **45** sets a posture of the bucket **17** at this time to the start point bucket posture Q1. For instance, a position for or an x-coordinate of the start point P1 in the forward and rearward directions is defined as “p1x”. A position or a z-coordinate of the start point P1 in the upward and downward directions is defined as “p1z”. The bucket rotation angle θ in the start point bucket posture Q1 is defined as “p1 θ ”.

(55) Calculation of a Direction and the Finish Point P3 of the Arm Distal End Target Locus Ta

(56) The target locus generation part **45** sets, calculates, or generates a position for the finish point P3 on the basis of a surface angle α , an intersection angle β , information about a form of the arm distal end target locus Ta, and an offset amount O.

(57) The target locus generation part **45** sets a direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta on the basis of the surface angle α and the intersection angle β . The “direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta” means a linear shifting direction from the start point P1 to the finish point P3. For instance, the direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta is represented by an angle of the arm distal end target locus Ta with respect to the horizontal direction H. Specifically, the target locus generation part **45** sets, as the direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta, a sum ($\alpha+\beta$) of the surface angle α detected by the contour detector **31** (see FIG. 1) and the intersection angle β set by the intersection angle setting part **41** (see FIG. 2). Even in the case where the arm distal end target locus Ta is not linear, the “direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta” may be a linear shifting direction from the start point P1 to the finish point P3. The direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta may be a shifting direction from the start point P1 to the finish point P3 in which the arm distal end target locus Ta extends (e.g., direction in which a tangent line, like a curvy form, of the arm distal end target locus Ta extends) at the start point P1. Hereinafter, the arm distal end target locus Ta being linear will be mainly described.

(58) The target locus generation part **45** calculates a position for the finish point P3, for example, in

a manner described below. The target locus generation part **45** calculates the position for the finish point P3 on the basis of a distance, a direct distance, or a shortest distance (length L) from the start point P1 to the finish point P3. For instance, the offset amount O is a distance (extension directional offset amount O2) between the finish point P3 and the surface A1 in the direction in which the arm distal end target locus Ta extends. At this time, the length L has a value obtained by subtracting the offset amount O from the distance from the start point P1 to the surface A1 on a straight line extending in the direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta.

(59) For example, the target locus generation part **45** calculates or sets, on the basis of the direction (at an angle of $\alpha+\beta$) of the arm distal end target locus Ta and the length L, a position coordinate (x-coordinate of p3x, z-coordinate of p3z) of the finish point P3 with, for example, the following equations:

$$p3x=p1x-L \cos(\alpha+\beta); \text{ and}$$

$$p3z=p1z-L \sin(\alpha+\beta).$$

(60) The position for the finish point P3 may be variously calculated. For instance, as shown in FIG. 4, the offset amount O is defined as a vertical directional distance (vertical directional offset amount O1) between the finish point P3 and the surface A1. In this case, the target locus generation part **45** may calculate, as the position for the finish point P3, an intersection between a straight line extending from the start point P1 (see FIG. 3) in the direction of the arm distal end target locus Ta and a plane based on shifting from the surface A1 by the offset amount O in parallel to the vertical direction.

(61) Determination of the Finish Point Bucket Posture Q3

(62) The target locus generation part **45** sets information set by the finish point bucket posture setting part **43** (see FIG. 2) as the finish point bucket posture Q3 illustrated in FIG. 3. Specifically, for instance, the bucket rotation angle θ (defined as “p3 θ ”) in the finish point bucket posture Q3 is 90°.

(63) Calculation of the Intermediate Point P2

(64) The target locus generation part **45** determines a position for the intermediate point P2 on the basis of the position for each of the start point P1 and the finish point P3. For instance, in a case where the position for the intermediate point P2 is a middle point between the start point P1 and the finish point P3, the target locus generation part **45** calculates a position coordinate (x-coordinate of p2x, z-coordinate of p2z) of the intermediate point P2 with the following equations:

$$p2x=(p1x+p3x)/2; \text{ and}$$

$$p2z=(p1z+p3z)/2.$$

Calculation of the Intermediate Point Bucket Posture Q2

(65) The target locus generation part **45** sets a posture between the start point bucket posture Q1 and the finish point bucket posture Q3 as the intermediate point bucket posture Q2. A bucket rotation angle θ (defined as “p2 θ ”) of the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 is an angle between a bucket rotation angle θ (i.e., p1 θ) in the start point bucket posture Q1 and a bucket rotation angle θ (i.e., p3 θ) in the finish point bucket posture Q3.

(66) The bucket target locus Tb may be set in such a manner that the bucket **17** rotates at a constant rotation speed from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3.

Specifically, for instance, the target locus generation part **45** may calculate the bucket rotation angle (p2 θ) in the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 with the following equation:

$$p2\theta=(p1\theta+p3\theta)/2.$$

(67) The bucket target locus Tb may be set in such a manner that the rotation speed of the bucket **17** changes in accordance with a change in the posture of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3. For instance, a rotation speed of the bucket **17** in the change from the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 to the finish point bucket posture Q3 may be faster than a rotation speed in the change from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the intermediate point bucket posture Q2. Specifically, the target locus generation part **45** may set the

intermediate point bucket posture Q2 on the basis of the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ set by the bucket rotation ratio setting part 44 (see FIG. 2). For instance, the target locus generation part 45 may calculate the bucket rotation angle θ (i.e., $p2\theta$) in the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 with the following equation:

$$p2\theta = p1\theta + (p3\theta - p1\theta) \times p2\theta_ratio.$$

(68) Here, a plurality of intermediate points P2 may be set. In this case, the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ may be set for each of the intermediate points P2.

(69) After Reaching the Finish Point P3

(70) A target locus of each of the arm distal end 15t and the bucket 17 after the arm distal end 15t reaches the finish point P3 is variously settable.

Example B1

(71) FIG. 5 is an illustration of an example of a rotation of the bucket 17 after the arm distal end 15t illustrated in FIG. 3 reaches the finish point P3. As illustrated in FIG. 5, after the arm distal end 15t reaches the finish point P3, the bucket 17 may rotate while the arm distal end 15t remains fixed at the position. At this time, the bucket 17 may rotate in a direction in which the bucket rotation angle θ increases (in a direction of scooping the excavation object A). The bucket 17 can scoop the excavation object A in accordance with the rotation of the bucket 17 in this manner. After the bucket 17 rotates to a predetermined angle, the arm distal end 15t may shift upward.

Example B2

(72) FIG. 6 is an illustration of an example of shifting of the arm distal end 15t and a rotation of the bucket 17 after the arm distal end 15t illustrated in FIG. 3 reaches the finish point P3. As illustrated in FIG. 6, after the arm distal end 15t reaches the finish point P3, the bucket 17 may rotate in the direction in which the bucket rotation angle θ increases while the arm distal end 15t shifts forward (in a pushing direction of the arm 15). In this case, the arm distal end 15t shifts forward. This keeps the excavation object A located in the rear of the bucket 17 from sliding further rearward. A larger surface angle α is more effective to suppress the rearward sliding of the excavation object A. For example, when the surface A1 is planar (see FIG. 8), the bucket 17 may rotate in a direction in which the bucket rotation angle θ increases in accordance with forward shifting of the arm 15. Further, the rotation of the bucket 17 in the direction in which the bucket rotation angle θ increases in accordance with the forward shifting of the arm 15 prevents the excavation quantity of the excavation object A from being too excessive, and keeps the excavation object A having been excavated from spilling out of the bucket 17. After the arm 15 shifts forward at a predetermined distance and the bucket 17 rotates to a predetermined angle, the arm distal end 15t may shift upward.

(73) Various Surface Angles α

(74) As described above, the target locus generation part 45 calculates, as shown in FIG. 3, the position for the finish point P3 on the basis of a detected position for the start point P1 and a detected surface angle α , and on the basis of a form of the arm distal end target locus Ta, an intersection angle β , and an offset amount O, each of the form, intersection angle, and the offset amount being set in advance. The target locus generation part 45 generates the arm distal end target locus Ta on the basis of the start point P1, the finish point P3, and the form of the arm distal end target locus Ta. For instance, in the case where the arm distal end target locus Ta is linear, the target locus generation part 45 defines a straight line connecting the start point P1 and the finish point P3 to each other as the arm distal end target locus Ta. The target locus generation part 45 can calculate the position for the finish point P3 on the basis of the start point P1, the surface angle α , the intersection angle β , the form of the arm distal end target locus Ta, and the offset amount O, regardless of the degree of the surface angle α . The target locus generation part 45 can uniquely determine the arm distal end target locus Ta at various surface angles α . For instance, FIG. 7 is an illustration corresponding to FIG. 3 except that a tilt degree of a surface A1 shown in FIG. 3 is steeper than that of the surface in the example illustrated in FIG. 3. The arm distal end target locus

Ta is uniquely determined for each of the surface A1 being a gentle slope (e.g., the surface angle α is larger than about 0° and smaller than 45°) as illustrated in FIG. 3 and the surface A1 being a steeper slope (e.g., the surface angle α is equal to or larger than 45°) as illustrated in FIG. 7. FIG. 8 is an illustration corresponding to FIG. 3 except that a surface A1 is planar unlike the surface in FIG. 3. As illustrated in FIG. 8, the arm distal end target locus Ta is uniquely determined even when the surface A1 is planar (e.g., the surface angle α is about 0° , see FIG. 7). Further, an excavation depth and a load applied to the attachment 12 are changeable owing to the changeable intersection angle β and offset amount O. Even in a change in the surface angle α , an appropriate setting of each of the intersection angle β and the offset amount O achieves suppression of an excessive load applied to the attachment 12 (enables release of the load) while ensuring the excavation quantity of the excavation object A.

(75) The target locus generation part 45 further sets the bucket target locus Tb on the basis of the start point bucket posture Q1 illustrated in FIG. 3, the finish point bucket posture Q3 set by the finish point bucket posture setting part 43 (see FIG. 2), and the uniquely determined arm distal end target locus Ta. The target locus generation part 45 can uniquely determine the bucket target locus Tb at various surface angles α .

(76) The effect by the target locus generation system 1 shown in FIG. 1 will be described below. The target locus generation system 1 includes the attachment 12, the posture detector 20, the contour detector 31, the contact detector 33, and the target locus generation part 45, the intersection angle setting part 41, and the offset amount setting part 42 each shown in FIG. 2. As illustrated in FIG. 1, the attachment 12 includes the boom 13, the arm 15, and the bucket 17. The boom 13 is tiltably attached to the machine main body 11. The arm 15 is rotatably attached to the boom 13. The bucket 17 is rotatably attached to the arm 15 for excavating the excavation object A. The posture detector 20 detects a posture of the attachment 12. The contour detector 31 detects information about a contour of the excavation object A. The contact detector 33 (see FIG. 2) detects contact of the distal end (the bucket distal end 17t) of the bucket 17 with the excavation object A. The target locus generation part 45 (see FIG. 2) generates the arm distal end target locus Ta being the target locus T of the distal end (arm distal end target locus 15) of the arm 15 illustrated in FIG. 3. The intersection angle setting part 41 (see FIG. 2) sets the intersection angle β between the surface A1 of the excavation object A and the arm distal end target locus Ta. The offset amount setting part 42 (see FIG. 2) sets the offset amount O being a distance between the finish point P3 of the arm distal end target locus Ta illustrated in FIG. 4 and the surface A1 of the excavation object A.

(77) The target locus generation part 45 (see FIG. 2) sets the position of the arm distal end 15t at a time when the contact detector 33 (see FIG. 2) detects a change to a state of contact of the bucket distal end 17t illustrated in FIG. 3 with the excavation object A from a state of no contact with the excavation object A at the start point P1 of the arm distal end target locus Ta.

(78) The target locus generation part 45 (see FIG. 2) sets information about a contour of the arm distal end target locus Ta in advance.

(79) The target locus generation part 45 (see FIG. 2) calculates a position for the finish point P3 on the basis of an angle (surface angle α) of the surface A1 of the excavation object A, an intersection angle β set by the intersection angle setting part 41 (see FIG. 2), information about the form of the arm distal end target locus Ta, and an offset amount O set by the offset amount setting part 42 (see FIG. 2).

(80) This configuration determines the position for the start point P1 of the arm distal end target locus Ta, and determines the position for the finish point P3 of the arm distal end target locus Ta. In this configuration, the target locus generation part 45 sets or presets information about the form of the arm distal end target locus Ta. Thus, the target locus generation system 1 can uniquely determine the arm distal end target locus Ta.

(81) In this configuration, the arm distal end target locus Ta is generated on the basis of the surface

angle α , the intersection angle β , the form of the arm distal end target locus Ta (information about the form), and the offset amount O. The arm distal end target locus Ta indicates a value set by the target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2), the intersection angle β indicates a value set by the intersection angle setting part **41** (see FIG. 2), and the offset amount O indicates a value set by the offset amount setting part **42** (see FIG. 2). Use of the form of the preset arm distal end target locus Ta, intersection angle β , and the offset amount O each being preset leads to facilitated calculation that enables generation of the arm distal end target locus Ta. This achieves suppression of the calculation load by the target locus generation part **45**. For instance, this configuration can suppress the calculation load more effectively than a configuration for generating the arm distal end target locus Ta on the basis of a load applied to the attachment **12** and than a configuration for generating the arm distal end target locus Ta on the basis of an amount of work performed by the bucket **17**.
(82) This configuration consequently succeeds in uniquely determine the target locus T while suppressing the calculation load for generating the target locus T (specifically, the arm distal end target locus Ta) of the attachment **12**.

(83) An appropriate setting of each of the intersection angle β and the offset amount O achieves suppression of the load applied to the attachment **12** while ensuring the excavation quantity of the excavation object A by the bucket **17**.

(84) Here, the arm distal end target locus Ta may be linear. The arm distal end target locus Ta viewed in a left-right direction of the upper slewing body **11b** is linear as illustrated in FIG. 3.

(85) This configuration suppresses a calculation load by the target locus generation part **45** more effectively than a configuration in which the arm distal end target locus Ta is not linear.

(86) As shown in FIG. 2, the target locus generation system **1** includes the finish point bucket posture setting part **43** that sets the finish point bucket posture Q3 illustrated in FIG. 3. The finish point bucket posture Q3 is a posture of the bucket **17** at a time when the arm distal end **15t** is at the finish point P3 of the arm distal end target locus Ta. The target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) generates the bucket target locus Tb being the target locus T of the bucket **17**.

(87) The posture of the bucket **17** detected by the posture detector **20** when the arm distal end **15t** is at the start point P1 of the arm distal end target locus Ta is defined as the start point bucket posture Q1. The target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) sets the bucket target locus Tb in such a manner that the bucket **17** continuously changes from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3 set by the finish point bucket posture setting part **43**.

(88) In the configuration, the start point bucket posture Q1 is a posture of the bucket **17** detected by the posture detector **20** when the arm distal end **15t** is at the start point P1. The finish point bucket posture Q3 is a posture set by the finish point bucket posture setting part **43** (see FIG. 2). Thus, the target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) is not required to generate the start point bucket posture Q1 and the finish point bucket posture Q3. This configuration can suppress the calculation load by the target locus generation part **45** (see FIG. 2) more effectively than a configuration which is required to generate the start point bucket posture Q1 and the finish point bucket posture Q3. This consequently succeeds in uniquely determine the bucket target locus Tb while suppressing the calculation load for generating the target locus (specifically, the bucket target locus Tb) of the attachment **12**.

(89) A posture of the bucket **17** at a time when the arm distal end **15t** is at the intermediate point P2 being a specific point between the start point P1 and the finish point P3 of the arm distal end target locus Ta is defined as the intermediate point bucket posture Q2. As shown in FIG. 2, the target locus generation system **1** includes the bucket rotation ratio setting part **44**.

(90) The bucket rotation ratio setting part **44** sets the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$. The bucket rotation ratio $2\theta_ratio$ is a ratio of a posture change amount of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 with respect to a posture change amount of the bucket **17** from the start point bucket posture Q1 to the finish point bucket posture Q3 as illustrated in FIG. 3. The target locus generation part **45** shown in FIG. 2 sets the

intermediate point bucket posture Q2 illustrated in FIG. 3 on the basis of the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ set by the bucket rotation ratio setting part **44**.

(91) In this configuration, the intermediate point bucket posture Q2 is determined on the basis of the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$. This configuration enables generation of the bucket target locus Tb in such a manner that the rotation speed of the bucket **17** changes before and after the intermediate point P2 in accordance with the setting of the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$. An appropriate setting of the bucket rotation ratio $p2\theta_ratio$ allows the bucket **17** to efficiently excavate the excavation object A.

(92) Modifications

(93) The embodiment described above may be modified in various ways. For instance, the arrangement and the shape of each of the constituent elements in the embodiment may be changed. For instance, the connection between or among the constituent elements shown in FIG. 2 may be changed. For instance, a procedure and each equation of the calculation related to the target locus T illustrated in FIG. 3 may be changed. For instance, the number of constituent elements may be changed, and one or more of the constituent elements are excludable. For instance, the constituent elements may be fixed to, or connected to or with each other in a direct way or an indirect way. For instance, the constituent elements are described as members different from one another or a part of the structure, but may cover a single member or a part of a specific member. For example, the constituent element described as a single member or a part of a specific member may cover a plurality of members or parts different from one another. Specifically, for example, each of the posture detector **20**, the contour detector **31**, and the contact detector **33** shown in FIG. 2 may serve as the other two elements. The constituent elements (including the intersection angle setting part **41** and the offset amount setting part **42**) of the controller **40** may be collectively provided in the single controller **40**, or may be separated into groups.

(94) The present invention provides a target locus generation system for a working machine that has: a machine main body; and an attachment including a boom tiltably attached to the machine main body, an arm rotatably attached to the boom, and a bucket rotatably attached to the arm for excavating an excavation object. The target locus generation system includes: a posture detector that detects a posture of the attachment; a contour detector that detects information about a contour of the excavation object; a contact detector that detects contact of a distal end of the bucket with the excavation object; and a controller. The controller is configured to receive information about a form of an arm distal end target locus being a target locus of a distal end of the arm, information about an intersection angle being an angle between a surface of the excavation object and the arm distal end target locus, and information about an offset amount being a distance between a finish point of the arm distal end target locus and the surface of the excavation object. The controller is configured to set a position of the distal end of the arm at a time when the contact detector detects a change to a state of the contact of the distal end of the bucket with the excavation object from a state of no contact with the excavation object at a start point of the arm distal end target locus. The controller is configured to set a position for the finish point of the arm distal end target locus on the basis of the contour of the excavation object detected by the contour detector, the intersection angle, the information about the form of the arm distal end target locus, and the offset amount. In this configuration, the arm distal end target locus may be linear.

(95) In the configuration, the controller is further configured to generate a bucket target locus being a target locus of the bucket. The controller may be configured to: further receive information about a finish point bucket posture being a posture of the bucket at a time when the distal end of the arm is at the finish point of the arm distal end target locus; and set the bucket target locus in such a manner that the posture of the bucket continuously changes to the received finish point bucket posture from a start point bucket posture being a posture of the bucket detected by the posture detector when the distal end of the arm is at the start point of the arm distal end target locus.

(96) In the configuration, the controller may be configured to: further receive information about a

bucket rotation ratio being a ratio of a posture change amount of the bucket from the start point bucket posture to an intermediate point bucket posture with respect to a posture change amount of the bucket from the start point bucket posture to the finish point bucket posture, the intermediate point bucket posture being a posture of the bucket at a time when the distal end of the arm is at an intermediate point being a specific point between the start point and the finish point of the arm distal end target locus; and set the intermediate point bucket posture on the basis of the received bucket rotation ratio.

(97) In the configuration, the controller may be configured to receive, as the contour of the excavation object, an angle of the surface of the excavation object to a predetermined reference plane; and set the position for the finish point of the arm distal end target locus on the basis of the angle of the surface, the intersection angle, the information about the form of the arm distal end target locus, and the offset amount.

(98) The configuration may further include a working machine that has: a machine main body; and an attachment including a boom tiltably attached to the machine main body, an arm rotatably attached to the boom, and a bucket rotatably attached to the arm for excavating an excavation object.

Claims

1. A target locus generation system for a working machine that has: a machine main body; and an attachment including a boom tiltably attached to the machine main body, an arm rotatably attached to the boom, and a bucket rotatably attached to the arm for excavating an excavation object, the target locus generation system comprising: a posture detector that detects a posture of the attachment; a contour detector that detects information about a contour of the excavation object; a contact detector that detects contact of a distal end of the bucket with the excavation object; and a controller, wherein the controller is configured to: receive information about a form of an arm distal end target locus being a target locus of a distal end of the arm, information about an intersection angle being an angle between a surface of the excavation object and the arm distal end target locus, and information about an offset amount being a distance between a finish point of the arm distal end target locus and the surface of the excavation object; set a position of the distal end of the arm at a time when the contact detector detects a change to a state of the contact of the distal end of the bucket with the excavation object from a state of no contact with the excavation object at a start point of the arm distal end target locus; and set a position for the finish point of the arm distal end target locus on the basis of the contour of the excavation object detected by the contour detector, the intersection angle, the information about the form of the arm distal end target locus, and the offset amount.

2. The target locus generation system according to claim 1, wherein the arm distal end target locus is linear.

3. The target locus generation system according to claim 1, wherein the controller is further configured to generate a bucket target locus being a target locus of the bucket, and the controller is configured to: further receive information about a finish point bucket posture being a posture of the bucket at a time when the distal end of the arm is at the finish point of the arm distal end target locus; and set the bucket target locus in such a manner that the posture of the bucket continuously changes to the received finish point bucket posture from a start point bucket posture being a posture of the bucket detected by the posture detector when the distal end of the arm is at the start point of the arm distal end target locus.

4. The target locus generation system according to claim 3, wherein the controller is configured to: further receive information about a bucket rotation ratio being a ratio of a posture change amount of the bucket from the start point bucket posture to an intermediate point bucket posture with respect to a posture change amount of the bucket from the start point bucket posture to the finish

point bucket posture, the intermediate point bucket posture being a posture of the bucket at a time when the distal end of the arm is at an intermediate point being a specific point between the start point and the finish point of the arm distal end target locus; and set the intermediate point bucket posture on the basis of the received bucket rotation ratio.

5. The target locus generation system according to claim 1, wherein the controller is configured to: receive, as the contour of the excavation object, an angle of the surface of the excavation object to a predetermined reference plane; and set the position for the finish point of the arm distal end target locus on the basis of the angle of the surface, the intersection angle, the information about the form of the arm distal end target locus, and the offset amount.

6. The target locus generation system according to claim 1, further comprising a working machine that has: a machine main body; and an attachment including a boom tiltably attached to the machine main body, an arm rotatably attached to the boom, and a bucket rotatably attached to the arm for excavating an excavation object.
